

# SIMS

School Information Management System

[Instruction & User Manual](#)

<https://sims-918c4.web.app>

Version 1.0 · July 2026

Multi-school platform for Zambian schools · CBC School-Based Assessment (SBA)

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# 1 • Introduction

SIMS is a web-based School Information Management System built for Zambian schools. It manages the full academic life of a school — student admission and records, teachers and teaching assignments, the CBC School-Based Assessment (SBA) workflow from marks entry through moderation, approval and ECZ export, report cards and transcripts, fee tracking, and student transfers between SIMS schools.

You use SIMS in a web browser — no installation is required. It works on computers, tablets and phones:

**Web address:** <https://sims-918c4.web.app>

Bookmark this address. Use a modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari).

## 1.1 Who uses SIMS — roles

Every user account has a role. Your role decides which menus you see and what you may do.

| Role                            | What they do in SIMS                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>School Administrator</b>     | Sets up the school (profile, structure, subjects), registers teachers and staff, creates login accounts, admits students, manages fees, and has full access to all modules.                                                           |
| <b>Head Teacher</b>             | Oversees the whole school: admits students, manages teachers and assignments, moderates and <b>approves</b> SBA results, initiates/decides transfers, views reports.                                                                  |
| <b>Deputy Head</b>              | Reviews and approves SBA submissions, monitors readiness, handles ECZ export, views reports.                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Head of Department (HOD)</b> | Builds SBA plans, enters marks where needed, <b>moderates</b> submitted class score sheets, monitors readiness and reports.                                                                                                           |
| <b>Teacher</b>                  | Works from “My Classes”: enters SBA marks for their own classes and submits them for review. Can view student records.                                                                                                                |
| <b>System Administrator</b>     | Platform level only — registers new schools onto SIMS, provisions the first School Administrator account, and enables optional paid add-ons (e.g. SBA evidence attachments) on a school's request. School staff never need this role. |

## 2 · Getting started — signing in

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### 2.1 Your account

You do not register yourself. Accounts are created for you:

- The **School Administrator** account is created when the school is registered on SIMS.
- **Staff accounts** (Head Teacher, Deputy, HOD, additional administrators) are created by the School Administrator under [Staff Accounts](#).
- **Teacher logins** are created by the School Administrator from the teacher's profile page.

In each case you will be given your **email address** and a **temporary password**. The temporary password is shown to your administrator **only once**, at the moment the account is created — keep it safe until your first sign-in.

### 2.2 First sign-in

- 1 Open **<https://sims-918c4.web.app>** in your browser.
- 2 Enter your email address and the temporary password, then press **Sign in**.
- 3 SIMS will immediately ask you to **set a new password**. You cannot use the system until you do. Enter the temporary password once more, choose a new private password, and confirm.
- 4 The app reloads and you land on your dashboard.

**Keep your password private.** Marks, approvals and payments are recorded against *your* account. There is currently no self-service “forgot password” — if you are locked out, contact your School Administrator / system administrator.

### 2.3 Changing your password later

Click **Change password** in the header (top-right, near your name) at any time. You will be asked for your current password and a new one.

### 2.4 Signing out

Use the **Sign out** button in the header. Always sign out on shared computers.

## 3 · Finding your way around

### 3.1 The screen layout

- **Header (top)** — your school's name and logo, the **academic context bar**, your name, [Change password](#) and [Sign out](#).
- **Sidebar (left)** — the menu. It only shows the pages your role may use, grouped under *Academics* and *Administration*. Red number badges show items waiting for your action (e.g. sheets to review, transfer requests).
- **Main area** — the page you are working on.

### 3.2 The academic context bar — important

In the header you will find dropdowns for **Year**, **Term**, and where relevant **Form** and **Stream**. Many pages (Teaching, SBA Plans, SBA Marks, My Classes, Reports) show data *for the selected year and term*. If a page looks empty, first check that the correct year and term are selected. Your selection is remembered on that device.

### 3.3 Menu overview

| Menu item                                           | Purpose                                                 | Who sees it                |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Dashboard                                           | Role-based cockpit: KPIs, pending actions, SBA pipeline | Everyone                   |
| My Classes                                          | A teacher's own classes and score sheets                | Teacher, HOD, Head, Deputy |
| Students / Student Registry                         | Student dashboard, full searchable register             | Admin, Head, Teacher       |
| Academic Structure                                  | Years, terms, forms (levels) and streams (classes)      | Admin manages; staff view  |
| Teachers                                            | Teacher HR registry and profiles                        | Admin, Head                |
| Transfers                                           | Student transfers between SIMS schools                  | Admin, Head                |
| Subjects                                            | Subject catalogue (incl. SBA flag)                      | Admin manages; staff view  |
| Teaching                                            | Assign teachers to stream + subject per term            | Admin, Head                |
| SBA Plans / Marks / Review / Readiness / ECZ Export | The full SBA workflow (Section 7)                       | Per role — see Section 7   |
| Reports                                             | School-wide SBA compliance and completion               | Admin, Head, Deputy, HOD   |
| School Profile                                      | School details, logo, grading scale                     | Admin                      |
| Staff Accounts                                      | Create/deactivate staff logins                          | Admin                      |
| Payments                                            | Fee register and clearance (non-government schools)     | Admin, Head                |

## 4 · Setting up your school (School Administrator)

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Do these once, in this order, before admitting students:

**Setup checklist:** ① School Profile → ② Academic Structure (year, terms, forms, streams) → ③ Subjects → ④ Register teachers → ⑤ Teaching assignments → ⑥ Staff accounts → ⑦ Admit students → ⑧ SBA plans.

### 4.1 School profile, logo and grading scale

Open [School Profile](#). Each section has its own **Edit** button:

- **General** — school name, type, ownership, principal, motto.
- **Contact** — phone, email, website.
- **Location** — province, district, physical and postal address.
- **Branding** — upload your school logo (image up to 2 MB). The logo appears in the header and on printed report cards, transcripts and certificates.
- **Grading scale** — the mark bands (e.g. 0–49 Fail ... 80–100 Excellent) used for the *Grade* column on report cards. Edit the band boundaries and labels to match your school's policy.
- **ECZ examinations** — the school's **examination centre number** (printed on the ECZ SBA export) and the **SBA submission deadline**. The deadline defaults to the ECZ norm of 31 January of the following year, but stays editable in case ECZ changes or extends it.
- **Registration & subscription** — read-only; school code, EMIS number and subscription are managed at platform level.

### 4.2 Academic structure

Open [Academic Structure](#). Work through the tabs:

- 1 **Years** — confirm the current academic year.
- 2 **Terms** — confirm the terms of the year.
- 3 **Levels** — the forms offered (F1–F4).
- 4 **Streams** — create a stream (class) for each form, e.g. F1 A, F1 B: choose the form, give a short **code** (A, B, GREEN...), a display name and a **capacity** (number of seats). The occupied count updates automatically as students are enrolled.

**Renaming a stream code:** editing a stream's code moves all its enrolments to the new code automatically. If the stream already has teaching assignments or SBA score sheets, the rename is refused — deactivate the old stream and create a new one instead.

## 4.3 Subjects

Open **Subjects** and add each subject taught: code, name, department, the **forms where it is offered**, and whether it is **SBA-enabled** (counts for CBC School-Based Assessment). Only SBA-enabled subjects appear in SBA planning.

## 4.4 Staff accounts

Open **Staff Accounts** to create logins for the Head Teacher, Deputy Head, HODs, or additional administrators:

- 1 Click **Create account**, enter name, email and role.
- 2 The temporary password is displayed **once** — copy it and hand it to the staff member securely.
- 3 On first sign-in they will be forced to set their own password (Section 2.2).

The same page lists all school accounts and lets you **Deactivate** / **Reactivate** them (you cannot deactivate yourself). Deactivated users can no longer sign in.

**Note:** Teacher logins are *not* created here — they are created from the teacher's profile page so the login is linked to the HR record (Section 5.2).

## 5 · Teachers & teaching assignments

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### 5.1 Registering a teacher

Open [Teachers](#) → **Register teacher**. Fill in the personal and professional details (name, gender, contact, department, employment type, qualification, TSC number). On save the teacher receives a permanent employee number (e.g. **EMP-000001**). This creates the *HR record* only — it is not yet a login.

The **Teacher Registry** lists all teachers; click one to open their profile, where an administrator can **Edit** details.

### 5.2 Giving a teacher a login account

- 1 Open the teacher's profile (the teacher must have an **email address** on record and be active).
- 2 In the **Login account** section click **Create login account**.
- 3 The email + temporary password are shown **once** — copy and deliver them securely.
- 4 The teacher signs in, sets a new password, and from then on sees [My Classes](#) and [SBA Marks](#) for their own classes.

### 5.3 Teaching assignments (who teaches what)

Open [Teaching](#). Check the year and term in the header context bar, then assign: **teacher + subject + stream + periods per week**. One teacher holds each (stream, subject) slot per term; assigning over an occupied slot warns you first. The **Teaching Load** view shows each teacher's periods, subjects, streams and workload percentage, so you can balance loads.

**Why this matters for SBA:** the teaching assignment is what links a teacher to a class score sheet — a teacher can only enter marks for classes assigned to them.



## 6 · Student management

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### 6.1 Admitting a student

Open [Students](#) → **Admit student** (administrators and head teachers). The wizard has five steps:

- 1 **Personal** — names, gender, date of birth. The admission number is generated automatically; the EMIS number is inherited from the school.
- 2 **Guardian** — parent/guardian details and contacts.
- 3 **Placement** — choose the form and a **stream** from the list (remaining seats are shown; full streams are disabled).
- 4 **Medical** — any medical notes.
- 5 **Review** — check everything and press **Admit**.

On success SIMS shows the generated numbers: student number (**STU-000123**), admission number (**ADM-2026-000045**) and guardian number (**GRD-000067**). Each learner is also minted a permanent **SIMS Learner ID** (**SL-2026-...**) that follows them for life, even across school transfers.

**Connectivity:** admission needs an internet connection — it reserves official numbers, which cannot be done offline.

### 6.2 Student registry

**Student Registry** is the full register: search by name or number, filter by form, stream, status, gender or admission year, and **Export CSV** for use in Excel. Click any row to open the student's profile.

### 6.3 The student profile

Tabs on the profile page:

- **Profile** — personal details, learner ID, status.
- **Enrollment** — enrolment history (form, stream, year).
- **Guardians** — linked guardians; click through to a guardian's profile and their other children.
- **Documents** — upload birth certificates, results slips etc. (PDF or images up to 10 MB), download or delete (delete is admin-only).
- **SBA** — the learner's SBA results per form year, plus the combined Forms 2+3 score (Section 7).
- **Timeline / Audit** — history of what happened to the record (audit is admin-only).

The header of the profile links to the printable **Report card**, **Transcript** and, for administrators, **Transfer out** (Section 9).

## 6.4 Class placement banner

If a student has no class assigned (for example, after arriving by transfer), an amber **“No class assigned”** banner appears at the top of their profile. Administrators and head teachers choose a stream there (capacity-aware) to place the learner.

## 7 · School-Based Assessment (SBA)

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### 7.1 The rules SIMS enforces

- SBA applies to **Forms 2 and 3**, in **SBA-enabled subjects**.
- Each subject follows an **assessment plan**: a list of tasks, each with its own maximum marks.
- Teachers record **raw scores per task**. SIMS computes the total out of 100:  $(\text{sum obtained} \div \text{sum maximum}) \times 100$ , rounded.
- **Schools never apply the ECZ 30%/40% weighting** — ECZ weights centrally. SIMS exports raw marks only. (This is the most common ECZ submission error; SIMS makes it impossible.)
- Once a class sheet is **approved** by school leadership, its marks are **frozen permanently** — nobody can alter them, which is what makes the results credible for export.

### 7.2 The workflow at a glance



A reviewer can also **Return** a sheet for correction (it reopens for the teacher, who fixes and resubmits), and administrators can withdraw a submitted sheet back to draft. Every action is recorded in the sheet's **history** with who, when and any comment.

### 7.3 SBA Plans (HOD / Head / Admin)

- 1 Open **SBA Plans**; check the year in the context bar.
- 2 Click **New plan**: pick the form (F2/F3) and an SBA-enabled subject offered at that form.
- 3 Add the tasks (name, type, maximum marks, optionally the term each task belongs to). The running total is shown.
- 4 Save as **draft**; when the plan is final, **Publish** it. Only published plans can be scored against, and a published plan's tasks are locked.

## 7.4 Entering marks (Teacher)

- 1 Open **My Classes** — each card is one of your classes with its SBA progress. Click a class (or open **SBA Marks** and pick form, stream and subject).
- 2 The score sheet lists your class roster with a column per task. Enter whole-number scores up to each task's maximum.
- 3 Mark any learner who does not take the subject as **Not taking**.
- 4 **Save** as you go — you can return any time while the sheet is in draft. The running total and percentage update live.
- 5 When every learner is complete, press **Submit for review**. The sheet locks for you and moves to the HOD.

**Returned sheet?** If a reviewer returns your sheet, it appears on your dashboard and My Classes with a **Returned** badge and the reviewer's comment. Correct the marks and submit again.

## 7.5 Moderation and approval (HOD / Deputy / Head)

Open **SBA Review**. Filter the class sheets by status. For each sheet you can **View** the marks, then:

- **Moderate** (HOD) — confirms departmental review of a submitted sheet.
- **Approve** (Head / Deputy) — final sign-off. The marks are recomputed server-side, **frozen**, and become read-only for everyone.
- **Return** — send back to the teacher with a comment explaining what to fix.

Each action can carry a comment; the per-sheet **History** shows the full trail, and a resubmitted sheet shows its version number (v2, v3...).

## 7.6 Readiness — is the school on track?

**SBA Readiness** shows one progress bar per form + subject, rolled up across its streams, from *Planning* through *Approved*. Use it to see at a glance which subjects are behind. Each class chip links to its printable class register.

## 7.7 Examination numbers and ECZ export

- 1 Open **SBA Marks** group → **Exam numbers** page (`/assessments/exam-numbers`): pick the form and stream, type each learner's ECZ examination number, and save (admin / head teacher).
- 2 Open **ECZ Export**: choose the form and subject. SIMS shows validation tiles — **Ready, Missing exam number, Not yet approved**.
- 3 Only learners whose marks are **approved (frozen)** and who have an exam number are exported. Fix the listed exceptions first.
- 4 Click **Export for ECZ** for the official CSV — it carries the ECZ header block (subject, form, school, examination centre number, year) followed by examination number, learner and raw mark — or **School copy (per-task)** for an internal file with every task column. You can also print the list.

**Deadline reminder:** if the SBA submission deadline is set in School Profile, the Export page shows how many days remain (ECZ normally requires scores by 31 January of the following year).

## 7.8 Evidence attachments (optional add-on)

ECZ requires schools to keep SBA evidence — marked student work, photos of practical work, rubrics — for at least 2 years for moderation. Schools with the **SBA evidence add-on** enabled see an **Evidence** panel below each class score sheet on the SBA Marks page:

- Staff attach **photos of student work** (models, projects, practicals) and **marked written work as PDF** — up to 10 MB per file. **Videos are not accepted**.
- Anyone on staff can view and download the files; only a School Administrator can delete them.
- The evidence stays with the score sheet, so a moderator can open a class and see both the frozen marks and the work behind them.

**Availability:** this feature is **off by default**. It is enabled per school by the system administrator on request, and is billed in addition to the school's subscription. Ask your provider if your school needs it.

## 8 · Report cards, transcripts & printing

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### 8.1 Report card

From a student's profile click **Report card**. It shows each subject's score and band, the class average and range, the learner's overall average and **class position**, your school's **grade** per subject (from the grading scale in School Profile), remarks and signature blocks.

- Use the **term selector** to print a term report (Midterm / End of term) — it computes over only that term's tasks — or the whole-year view, which uses final frozen marks where approved.
- In private schools, report cards are **withheld** for learners whose fees are not cleared (Section 10).

### 8.2 Transcript

From the profile click **Transcript**: the learner's identity (including the SIMS Learner ID), full enrolment history, SBA results per form year, and the combined Forms 2+3 score out of 20, with a head-teacher signature block.

### 8.3 How to print or save as PDF

- 1 Open the report card, transcript, certificate or class register.
- 2 Click the **Print** button on the page (or press Ctrl+P / Cmd+P).
- 3 In the browser dialog choose your printer, or choose **"Save as PDF"** as the destination to keep an electronic copy.

The app's menus and header are removed automatically in print — you get a clean document with the school logo and details at the top.

## 9 · Student transfers between SIMS schools

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When a learner moves to another school that also uses SIMS, the transfer is handled digitally. The learner's permanent SIMS Learner ID follows them; their record and SBA history travel in a sealed “transfer envelope”. Schools never see each other's registers — only the envelope of the learner being transferred. Only administrators and head teachers can transfer students.

### 9.1 Sending a learner (the releasing school)

- 1 Open the student's profile → **Transfer out** (available for active students).
- 2 Enter the receiving school's **school code** (e.g. SCH-000123 — obtain it from that school), the reason and effective date.
- 3 Send. The request is assigned a transfer reference (**TRF-2026-000012**) and appears in your **Transfers** → **Outgoing** tab.
- 4 While it is still pending you may **Cancel** it from the Outgoing tab.

### 9.2 Receiving a learner

- 1 Open **Transfers** → **Incoming** (a red badge on the menu shows waiting requests).
- 2 Click a request to preview the envelope: identity, enrolment history, guardians, SBA record.
- 3 Choose **Accept**, **Reject**, or **Request info** (with a note back to the sender).
- 4 On acceptance SIMS automatically imports the learner: new student and guardian records in your school, the same Learner ID, and their history attached. The sending school's record is closed as “transferred”.
- 5 Open the imported student (the completed request links straight to them) and use the “**No class assigned**” banner to place them in a stream (Section 6.4).

### 9.3 Transfer certificate

After the transfer, the releasing school can print a **Transfer certificate** from the (now transferred) student's profile — identity, admission and leaving dates, destination school and the TRF reference, with a signature block.

## 10 · Fees & payments (private and grant-aided schools)

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Open **Payments** (administrators and head teachers; the page is not shown in government schools, where education is free by law).

- **Record a payment** — learner, amount (Kwacha), reference/note. Payments form an append-only ledger; to correct a mistake, record an adjustment (negative amount) rather than editing history.
- **By-learner view** — every active learner with their total paid; click a learner to see their ledger.
- **Cleared toggle** — mark a learner's fees as cleared for the year (also usable for bursaries with no payment records).
- **Export CSV** — for reconciliation in Excel.

**Report-card gate (private schools):** a learner's report card is withheld until they are marked cleared. Teachers cannot open the card at all; administrators and head teachers see it with a “withheld” warning banner. Grant-aided schools keep the fee register without any report-card gating.

## 11 · Reports & compliance

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**Reports** is the leadership view for the current year:

- **KPIs** — SBA classes, how many are fully approved, awaiting approval, still in marks entry, or not yet planned; Form 2/3 learner counts.
- **Compliance by subject** — a progress bar and stage badge per subject, sorted least-ready first, so problem subjects surface at the top.
- **By-form completion** summary.
- **Export CSV / Print** for meetings and record-keeping.

The **Dashboard** gives leadership a daily cockpit: learner/teacher counts, SBA pipeline, and a “needs attention” panel that mirrors the red menu badges.

## 12 · Working offline

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SIMS caches data on your device, so brief internet drops are tolerated:



| Works offline                                                     | Needs a connection                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Viewing students, teachers, classes and previously loaded pages   | Signing in                                         |
| Entering and saving SBA marks for a sheet you have already opened | Admitting a student (number reservation)           |
|                                                                   | Submitting a sheet for review; moderation/approval |
|                                                                   | Creating accounts, transfers, uploads, exports     |

Offline changes sync automatically when the connection returns. If marks were approved while you were offline, your late edits will be rejected — approved marks stay frozen.

## 13 · Testing tools (demo data)

**For the testing phase only.** These pages create **real records** in your school. Use them only in a test school, never in a school holding real learner data.

- **SBA Demo Data** (`/dev/seed`, administrators) — one click sets up a demo Mathematics F2 class: stream, learners, a teacher, a teaching assignment and exam numbers, ready for walking through the whole SBA flow.
- **Bulk Admit** (`/dev/bulk-admit`, administrators) — admits a batch of test learners quickly.

## 14 · Troubleshooting & FAQ

| Problem                                                | What to do                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I can't see a menu item this manual describes.         | Your role does not include it (Section 1.1). Ask your School Administrator if you believe your role is wrong.                                                                |
| A page looks empty (no classes, no plans...).          | Check the <b>Year / Term</b> selectors in the header context bar — you may be looking at the wrong term (Section 3.2).                                                       |
| My role was changed but nothing happened.              | Sign out and sign in again to pick up the new permissions.                                                                                                                   |
| I forgot my password.                                  | There is no self-service reset yet — contact your School Administrator / system administrator.                                                                               |
| The temporary password was lost before first sign-in.  | It cannot be shown again. The administrator should contact the system administrator to re-issue the account.                                                                 |
| I can see a score sheet but cannot edit it.            | Either the sheet has been submitted/approved (locked), or the class is not assigned to you (read-only). Check its status and your teaching assignment.                       |
| Submit button is disabled on my score sheet.           | Every learner needs a score for every task (or a "Not taking" mark), and unsaved changes must be saved first.                                                                |
| Marks are wrong on an <b>approved</b> sheet.           | Approved marks are frozen by design and cannot be edited by anyone at the school. Raise the dispute with school leadership; the sheet's history shows who approved and when. |
| A learner is missing from the ECZ export.              | The export page tells you why: marks not yet approved, or examination number missing. Fix and re-export.                                                                     |
| Report card won't open for a learner (private school). | The learner's fees are not marked cleared — see Payments (Section 10).                                                                                                       |
| "Permission denied" errors appear.                     | You tried an action your role doesn't allow, or your session is stale — sign out and in. If it persists, report it: it may be a bug worth logging during testing.            |
| The stream I want to admit into is greyed out.         | It is full. Increase its capacity in Academic Structure or choose another stream.                                                                                            |

### Reporting problems during the testing phase

SIMS is under active testing. When something behaves unexpectedly, please note: **who you were signed in as (role), the page, what you did, what you expected, and what happened** — a screenshot helps greatly — and send it to the project team. Your feedback drives the next release.